



Counting Happiness

BSG Statistics Department Monthly Newsletter



Dashing forward with the spirit of
I AM THAT ONE DISCIPLE



THE SPIRIT OF MARCH 16: I AM THAT ONE DISCIPLE

Dear Mathematicians of Happiness,
Thank you very much for your sustained dedicated efforts. March is the month of mentor and disciple, the month when we commemorate March 16th, Kosen-rufu day. The significance of this day lies in the disciple taking the baton of kosen-rufu from the mentor and assuming equal responsibility to advance kosen-rufu.

March 16, 1958, 6000 dedicated youth gathered to respond to Toda Sensei. Amongst them, there was one Shin'ichi Yamamoto who stood up alone at first to take forward the baton of kosen-rufu. Because of Shinichi's fierce determination and wholehearted fight to respond to his mentor, everyone else's spirits were roused. Shin'ichi was the spark to ignite the fighting spirit, joy, and breakthrough in the lives of all members.

Ikeda Sensei writes quoting Toda Sensei, **"As long as there is a core of youth - no, even a single true disciple - we will achieve kosen-rufu. Who has been that one disciple? Who**

has given his life to spreading Nichiren Buddhism around the world, just as Mr. Toda taught? I am proud and confident to say that I am that one disciple" (NHR 30, Part 2, Vow, p. 465).

'I am that one disciple' is not just a phrase, it is a spirit with which each one of us have to advance. As statistics incharges, it is with this spirit we need to take lead in doing shakubuku and reach out to new lives. With new initiatives and features in BDS from time to time (e.g. Adding new friends in meetings other than discussion meeting) let's empower each other and support one another in taking care of each life in BDS.

Our youthful resolve and spirit will create a ripple effect in the advancement of kosen-rufu as we progress towards our cherished goal of one million. Almost three months of this year have passed by-so let's DASH forward, let's advance, let's take everyone along, let's take lead and let's win for Sensei.

- *By ABACUS Editorial Team* ★★

ETERNAL GUIDELINE FOR THE STATISTICS DEPARTMENT

"A membership card is not a piece of paper; it is the life of one person. In it, the life pulsates, the personality is contained, and the drama of awakening in faith and rebirth is played out. There exist the human-to-human bonds of warm trust. Because we have been cherishing each person to the utmost, we see the magnificent development of the Soka Gakkai today."

- Daisaku Ikeda (December 15, 2002)

LIVING BASED ON NAM-MYOHO-REN-GE-KYO

I once asked Mr. Toda if teaching others about Nichiren Buddhism is, in effect, teaching ourselves.

He responded by touching on the essence of faith, declaring that when we teach others about Nichiren Buddhism, we are living based on Nam-myoho-enge-kyo. That's all there is to it; there is no technique or trick to it, he added.

How wonderful it is to live based on Nam-myoho-enge-kyo!

It means we are dedicating ourselves to our mission as envoys of the Buddha, as Bodhisattvas of the Earth. It means that the spirit of sharing the Mystic Law with others is at the core of our lives. When this is the case, the greatness of Buddhism will be apparent in our attitude toward living and our view of life and death. As long as this conviction and pride in our faith are our core, we will naturally want to speak to others about how wonderful our Buddhist practice is. At the same time, we can demonstrate the truth of Buddhism through our example. This is what it means to align our lives with the rhythm of Nam-myoho-enge-kyo.

We are never for a moment separate from the life state of Buddhahood. It is always with us, present in us, and one with us. *The Record of the Orally Transmitted Teachings* says: "The Buddha nature and the Buddha body are both none other than the bodies and minds that constitute living beings" (OTT: SG 236; EG 359). Therefore, we will invariably attain a life condition in which we can freely employ the wisdom, power, and courage of the Buddha.



THE GREAT LIFE STATE OF BUDDHAHOOD FLOWS FORTH

Mr. Toda declared: "Propagating the Mystic Law in the Latter Day of the Law simply means deciding, 'My life is none other than Nam-myoho-enge-kyo!'"

We are ordinary people inundated by all manner of problems and striving earnestly to navigate our way through the turbulence of society. But when we make the Daishonin's wish for the compassionate propagation of the Mystic Law our personal mission, we unlock a powerful life force that can overcome even the fiercest onslaughts of karma. The life state of Buddhahood flows forth moment by moment.

(Creating a century of humanism in which all can shine, p. 22-23) ★★

BSG STATISTICS DEPARTMENT MOTTO

"With the heart of oneness of mentor and disciple, we cherish each life as Bodhisattva of the Earth and strive diligently towards the dynamic and eternal advancement of Kosen-rufu."



STATISTICS AS THE PULSE OF THE CHAPTER: A JOURNEY OF CONNECTION AND GROWTH

Sandeep Garg

**Chapter Statistics Incharge
Delhi West Area**

I started practicing Nichiren Buddhism in May 2015. I have always felt comfortable working with numbers and data, and even before formally assuming the responsibility as district statistics incharge, I wholeheartedly supported my leaders in managing records.

While learning to handle responsibilities, I reminded myself of Sensei's words: **"Even if it is just one small step, keep moving forward day after day. Don't get disheartened and don't give up!"** (Living the Gosho, Words of Encouragement, p. 17).



Scan to listen to
the experience

With deep gratitude, I am currently serving as chapter statistics incharge. I have come to see that statistics is the backbone of our chapter – not just numbers, but a means to treasure each precious life and keep every member connected. Though our chapter Sector 40-Ryan has a large membership of 416 members and 325 friends, not all are actively connected. Some have shifted out and some attended only one or two meetings. At times, no response from members felt discouraging, and earlier I even felt if such names could be removed

from the database. However, through sincere prayer, my perspective changed. Instead of seeing them as inactive, I now see them as members waiting to re-connect. I pray for each person to rediscover the warmth of this practice. As a result, a few members have started responding again.

Discussion meetings have become a powerful source of encouragement. Compared to last year's average attendance of around 45, this year shows a significant upward trend. By chanting with statistics incharges during home visits and resolving database challenges together, we have strengthened our bond. We ensure that attendance is marked on time before the freezing date. Further on home visits, I have also been able to guide members to use the BSG Connect Plus mobile app.

Member and friend transfers bring me immense joy, as they reflect genuine life-to-life connections. Through heartfelt one-to-one dialogue and close coordination with fellow statistics incharges across BSG, each interaction becomes a meaningful opportunity to create value. By sharing division-wise data and friends ageing report, I help leaders in taking care of each life in the chapter.

Regularly opening BDS, reviewing attendance and subscription reports helps track chapter growth and helps in encouraging members for timely renewals of VC and Soka Successors. Our VC subscription have increased from 16 in January 2025 to 33 in January 2026.

With faith in each person's limitless potential, we approach

chapter appointments with the spirit of fostering capable people. In every appointment cycle, we have around 4-5 new appointments across different levels. This year too, more capable individuals are ready to step forward.

With the introduction of San Dai Jo – West Delhi campaign this year, I have experienced statistics as the living pulse of the chapter. By maintaining accurate data, ensuring timely follow-ups, and sharing regular updates with leaders, I am contributing towards cherishing each life.

This year has been truly encouraging, around 40-50 dialogues were carried out across the chapter. Out of which, 12 new friends have been introduced and 4 friends have become members. Personally, I introduced a family of three, and two of them have already attended a discussion meeting. Districts are also organizing weekday discussion meetings to ensure maximum attendance. Above all, daimoku has become the driving force at every level – district, chapter, and one-to-one encouragement – uniting us and strengthening our determination.

At the same time, my journey in faith has been one of inner victory. Despite financial challenges and a prolonged work struggle, I continue to move forward with faith and conviction. Even without a visible breakthrough yet, I feel victorious – because I am still chanting, fostering others, and advancing with Sensei.

With this spirit, I am determined to reach out to the friends in the BDS, support new members, and introduce at least 10 new lives in 2026. ★★



Timely attendance marking is an expression of reporting victory to Ikeda Sensei by statistics incharges!

Introducing the zones where all the districts marked the '**Discussion Meeting**' attendance in the month of February 2026.

*We accord these zones as '**MATHEMATICIANS OF THE MONTH**' for February 2026.*

MATHEMATICIANS OF THE MONTH

Delhi - East

Ananda - Lotus
Expressway - Jaypee
Greno West
Indirapuram
Indraprastha
Noida - Vasundhara
Noida City Centre
Noida West
Sahibabad - Meerut
Shahdara - Anand Vihar
Vaishali

North India

Amritsar
Chandigarh
Jaipur Midtown
Jammu
Lucknow
Lucknow - Gorakhpur
Ludhiana & Jalandhar
Mansarovar
Mohali
Panchkula West

Delhi - North

Ashoka
Central Pitampura
Delhi University
Mansarovar - Naraina
Model Town - Chatrasal
Pusa
Rohini

South India

Bangalore South Central
Bangalore South East
Bangalore South West
Chennai Central
Chennai East

West India - 2

Chembur - Ghatkopar
Goa
Juhu Vile Parle
Khar Santacruz BKC
Sion Parel
Tardeo Malabar
Worli Prabhadevi

Delhi - South

Badkal - Faridabad
C R Park - Kalkaji
Charmwood
Faridabad
Green Park
Lajpat Nagar
Lodhi Garden
Malviya Nagar
New Friends Colony
Sainik Farm
Saket
Sarita Vihar

East India

Central Kolkata
Dumdum
Odisha North 1
Odisha North 2
Odisha South
Seven Sisters
Tolly Jadavpur - Bihar
Upper Assam

Delhi - West

Aravali
DLF 1 & 3
DLF 2 & 4
Dwarka - Palam
Dwarka - Uttam Nagar
Epicentre
Golf Course
Janak Puri
Nirvana
Palam Vihar
Shanti Path
Sohna
Vasant Kunj East
Vasant Kunj West
Vikaspuri

West India - 1

Ahmedabad Central
Ahmedabad Outer
Andheri East
Baner - Central
Baroda
Kandivali Dahisar West
Kandivali East Dahisar
Koregaon - Airport

Magarpatta - Kharadi
Mira Virar
Mulund Ghatkopar
Nasik - Aurangabad
PCMC - Aundh
Powai
Pune South 1
Pune South Hills
Thane - Kalyan

MEETINGS IN MARCH 2026

7th March 2026

Cubs Division Meeting &
Young Lions Meeting



**Region Statistics
Incharge**

to mark the attendance

8th March 2026

Gosho Study
Meeting



**District Statistics
Incharge**

to mark the attendance

29th March 2026

Discussion
Meeting



**District Statistics
Incharge**

to mark the attendance

Let's promptly mark the attendance of the above meetings and report victory as statistics incharges!



15th March 2026 - Youth Division New Friends Festival

Commemorating March 16



Let us warmly welcome New Friends and
**promptly mark the attendance of all New Friends (add all New Friends)
and Friends who attend the New Friends Meeting in the BDS.**



HAPPINESS COUNTER



BSG

2 9 2 6 1 9



Youth Division

1 4 4 0 7 7

Q. How can we carry out leadership appointments with faith, unity and accuracy?

Leadership appointments are not just administrative tasks. They are an important responsibility in advancing kosen-rufu. Each appointment reflects trust, unity and our collective prayer for the growth and happiness of every member.

Ikeda Sensei says, **“Leadership positions within Soka Gakkai are positions of responsibility. They are emblems of courageous individuals who have voluntarily taken on the mission of expanding kosen-rufu, and who battle against powerful negative forces and resolutely protect their fellow members”** (Kosen-rufu: Our Mission, Vol 1, p. 154).

To ensure smooth functioning during the current appointment cycle, we are sharing the following **quick reference tables** for clarity and accuracy in BDS.

When roles are clearly understood, work becomes smooth and harmonious.

Appointment Flow in BDS

Proposed Appointment	Who initiates the appointment in BDS	Appointment Recommending Committee (ARC)	Appointment Approving Committee 1 (AAC1)	Appointment Approving Committee 2 (AAC2)
Block Chief	District Statistics Incharge	District	Chapter	Region
District Chief	Chapter Statistics Incharge	Chapter	Region	Zone
Chapter Chief	Region Statistics Incharge	Region	Zone	Area
Region Chief	Zone Statistics Incharge	Zone	Area	All India
Zone Chief	Area Statistics Incharge	Area	All India	All India

This table helps us remember:

- ***Who initiates the proposal.***
- ***Which level recommends.***
- ***Which levels approve.***

Marking of Interaction & Appointment

Proposed Appointment	Who marks the interaction	Who marks the appointment
Block Chief	Chapter Statistics Incharge	Chapter Statistics Incharge
District Chief	Region Statistics Incharge	Region Statistics Incharge
Chapter Chief	Zone Statistics Incharge	Region Statistics Incharge
Region Chief	Area Statistics Incharge	Zone Statistics Incharge
Zone Chief	Area Statistics Incharge	Area Statistics Incharge

Please ensure:

- ***Interaction is properly marked.***
- ***Consent is obtained from the proposed leader on mail.***
- ***Appointment is marked only after appointment is announced in a meeting.***

Minimum Requirements for Force Push

Force Push is a support feature – not a shortcut.

It can only be used by the statistics incharge and only after minimum required approvals.

Proposed Appointment	ARC Minimum Approvals	AAC1 Minimum Approvals	AAC2 Minimum Approvals
Block Chief	Any 2 District Chiefs	Any 3 Chapter Chiefs	Any 3 Region Chiefs - different divisions
District Chief	Any 3 Chapter Chiefs	Any 3 Region Chiefs - different divisions	Any 4 Zone Chiefs - different divisions
Chapter Chief	Any 3 Region Chiefs - different divisions	Any 4 Zone Chiefs - different divisions	Any 4 Area Chiefs - different divisions
Region Chief	Any 4 Zone Chiefs - different divisions	Any 4 Area Chiefs - different divisions	Any 4 National Leaders - different divisions
Zone Chief	Any 4 Area Chiefs - different divisions	Any 4 National Leaders - different divisions	Any 4 National Leaders - different divisions

Force Push must never replace in-person discussions of ARC and AAC meetings.

Let us use these quick reference tables carefully, and complete every appointment with faith in our hearts, unity in our discussions, and accuracy in BDS.

****Read more about appointment process in the March 2025 issue of ABACUS***



ABACUS Editorial Team, in conversation with

Arnab Bhattacharjee

Region Statistics Incharge, East India Area



Please share your journey of being a statistics incharge?

My journey as a statistics incharge began in 2019 with the responsibility of chapter statistics incharge.

Initially, it felt like an added responsibility alongside many others. But the more I worked with the data I understood the importance of Sensei's guidance for the statistics department: "A membership card is not a piece of paper; it is the life of one person" (*BSG Statistics Department Handbook, p. 39*).

This guidance deeply encouraged me to fight alongside members, responding to transfers and praying for each life. What first felt like a

a monotonous task, gradually became a way to develop the spirit of responding quickly to Sensei. This became a journey of elevating my inner self, raising above my lesser ego and working for the happiness of people.



How has being a statistics incharge helped you personally?

One major change for me, was becoming more prompt and responsive. Earlier, I was quite lethargic and would procrastinate a lot.

The turning point came when I realized that numbers would stay as numbers unless we each out to the person behind them. This pushed me to home visit members and last year, after

a lot of stagnation, I did around 135 home visits, breaking through my own limitations. Meeting people, encouraging them, and becoming their friend transformed me greatly. This helped in my professional life as well, where I could support others and ensure no one felt alone.

My thinking changed completely - I no longer saw statistics as just an organizational agenda. Accurate and timely data helps us understand the real situation of the organization: where encouragement is needed, where new members require support, and where home visits are required. This insight dissolved the stagnation I once felt in faith. I felt strongly that every life deserves happiness and that I should never give up supporting people.



Please share your experience of working on BDS?

Initially, we had some technical challenges which got resolved with time and faith.

I feel BDS is really the need of the hour. Of course, we were accustomed to MDS but BDS brings greater clarity. The dashboard, the appointment module, subscription data and more makes everything comprehensive.

A system such as BDS which is elaborate and inclusive is important as we move towards 2030 and 1 million members.



Do you read the ABACUS regularly? What do you think is the importance of ABACUS personally for you?

In our region, ABACUS is widely shared

and in the statistics incharges group, we share our favourite part or learnings from the ABACUS which encourages everyone. Personally, I may not always read it end-to-end, but this habit of sharing ABACUS and key points encourages us to read it every month.

ABACUS is important because of its content. Sensei's guidance helps me fight daily challenges and stay grounded. The practical information such as updates on modules, marking attendance, or recording new friends helps us work effectively with BDS.

The dialogue section, experiences, puzzle, and recognition as mathematician of the month brings great joy. I think all across East India, members feel encouraged to see their zone name published.

So, overall, ABACUS motivates us to carry out our responsibilities sincerely.



What is your determination as statistics incharge towards 2030?

Towards 2030, I am determined to expand the network of happiness through genuine care and dialogue and not simply with numbers in BDS.

I want to make dialogues and shakubuku a natural way of life. For this, I pray to the Gohonzon to encounter those who are suffering and introduce them to the realm of faith.

Together with all district statistics incharges of the region, I will move forward with the spirit of leaving no one behind believing that faith first will bring the numbers. ★★



A quick BDS brain-teaser! Choose the correct option for each statement given below in respect to the BDS.

1. **(Chapter / Region)** chief's interaction is marked by zone statistics incharge.
2. **(Dy Block Chiefs & above / Dy. District Chiefs & above)** can use the Ticket System feature in BDS.
3. In the BDS, **(DSI / CSI)** initiates the Gohonzon application for a member.
4. **(Ticket Summary / Follow up Action)** window shows the updated status of the ticket.
5. An introduction request can be raised on BDS through **(all logins/chapter login)**.
6. Members need to send their request for obtaining letter of introduction to BSG overseas department 1 month in advance for **(short visits/relocation)**.
7. We create introduction in the BDS when we wish to raise an introduction request **(outside the district / within the district)**.
8. Members can provide consent for their Gohonzon application **(by logging into BDS / on the email received on their registered email id)**.

Please send your answers at statistics@bharatsokagakkai.org by 31th March 2026

OUR VICTORIOUS COMRADES WHO PARTICIPATED IN THE PUZZLE

- | | |
|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| ★ Gyana Ranjan Jena – East India | ★ Sonia Jhingon – West India 1 |
| ★ Kailash Gajare – West India 1 | ★ Sudeshna B Baruah – South India |
| ★ Muskaan Gulabani – West India 2 | |

ANSWERS OF LAST MONTH'S PUZZLE

1.	Because we have problems, we can become happy. By facing our struggles head-on, we can become even happier. This is the heart of faith and the essence of life.
2.	A heart filled with gratitude is strong, profound, and rich. When we dedicate our lives to the path of mentor and disciple, we can bring forth limitless power, breakthrough our limitations, and win without fail in all our endeavors.
3.	"A person can know another's mind by listening to the voice". Words spoken from the heart will resonate with others. When we sincerely reach out and talk with our friends, we uplift our own hearts, too.
4.	Our Buddhist practice is not an obligation, but a right that enables us to attain Buddhahood. We will gain benefit in direct proportion to our own determination and efforts in faith.
5.	Advance each day! Win each day! This is the Gakkai way of life. After all, not advancing is retreating, and Buddhism is win or lose.
6.	Starting the morning off right is key to getting the most out of each day. When we win in the morning, it's a win for the entire day. If we make this a habit, we will win in all areas of our lives.
7.	No matter what obstacles lie ahead, keep chanting earnestly and boldly take a step forward. Doing so will allow you to bring forth immeasurable wisdom and open the way to making the impossible possible.



BDS HELPDESK

In case of any query or assistance on BDS, please write to:
helpdesk@bharatsokagakkai.org
or create a ticket on BDS under 'Ticket System'.



WE WANT YOUR FEEDBACK

We look forward to hearing from you! Please write to us if you have any feedback on the newsletter or if you wish to share your experience as statistics incharge; please mail us at :
statistics@bharatsokagakkai.org